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MCH1028 Introduction to Professional Communication

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Take-home case study. Apply communications theory to a case study situation and make recommendations in notes format (2000 words +/- 5%)

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Introduction Page3

PR Method Page3-4

Advertising Choice Page4-5

Sales Promotion Page5-6

Direct Market and Building Database Page6-8

Conclusion Page8

Reference List Page9

Alana Dotas, a UK high-end luxury brand of home fragrances, promotes a new type of environmental friendly soy candles with three different functions--Relax, Revive and Romance. This article will introduce some communication plan for the launch of the Soy Wax Scents collection, from four parts--PR, advertising, sales promotion and direction market.

This part will introduce how to use PR to help Alana Dotas with the launch of soy wax scents candle to the UK market. The tactics of 3Es and Pub which is Editorial, Events, Electronic, Publications (and Mixed Media) are very important to the product launches. Before product launch, Alana Dotas can use owned and shared media, which is the brand's instagram, to post some pictures and faded videos in order to increase the awareness and interest of the new soy wax scent candle. Because of the epidemic, companies should use online live broadcasts to hold product launches(events and electronic). Before the launch of the soy scented candle product, give samples to these media and influential young bloggers who have a stance on protecting the environment for evaluation(Publications and mixed media, also editorial). This in order to earning goodwill and mutual understanding to help protect and promote an organisation's reputation. At the same time as the product launch, commentary articles and videos from various media will be released, a well-prepared video must also be shown at the product launch to showcase the features of this new soy scented candle, and some lucky draws can be held in the live broadcast at the end of the product launch, the winners will receive a year's worth of soybean candles as prizes(Publications and mixed media, also electronic). After the press conference, some activities can also be held through shared media, such as encouraging users to post their experience and feedback on social media such as Instagram because of the highly instagrammable features of the Alana Dotas brand, then select some high-quality and widely disseminated blogs as winner(events and electronic). These bloggers will have the chance to win a all-expenses paid trip to Paris, and appeared in an ad for soy scented candles, which of course was filmed in

Paris. In addition, the product also requires a representative individual to endorse the soy scented candle, which is the opinion leader. The representative must be eco-friendly, very charming to match the product's characteristics, and young, because the target customer for this soy scented candle is young people. And PR also needs to do a lot of communication with trade customers, because PR is different from advertising, PR also needs to understand the ideas of stakeholders to get their support, because a large part of the sales of soy scented candles need to rely on these trades customer.

Advertising is the most common and fastest way to sell. It generally spreads in five ways. The first is Press, such as the advertisements that appear in magazines and newspapers. Followed by TV, people usually watch TV interspersed with advertisements. The third is the radio. In some taxis, the driver sometimes turns the device into radio mode to play the radio station. Passengers can get information about a product or activity through this method, or some elderly people are used to listening to the radio. There is also a very common way of outdoor advertising, giant billboards that people see on the highway, billboards on the street, advertisements posted on the outside of buses on the road, and even some people sending out flyers, these are all It belongs to the appearance of outdoor advertising. More than half are regular media multitaskers in the UK, and a quarter of these people regularly watch TV and interact with what they watch, according to figures from the 2013 Ofcom Market Report. In addition, a quarter of the more than half of those people watch regularly to accomplish some media tasks. This data clearly shows that the main source of information for contemporary people is through electronic media such as television or mobile phones. This has also developed some communication platforms such as Instagram, TikTok and YouTube. And these platforms will also be one of the important ways of advertising dissemination. Alana Dotas now has a certain height on Instagram, so you can try to develop other platforms, such as TikTok which is a short video platform, many young people will share their daily life on this platform, and some people will be loved

by the audience and receive more attention which can explore the market and increase the revenue especially for young people--the target market. In addition to promoting through your own business account, a better way to generate purchases is to partner with popular publishers on the platform. Through some short videos with attractive stories, they are displayed in the form of micro-movies for advertisement placement which can not only attract new consumers ,but also regain the love of old customers. These methods are often more acceptable to the audience and can be more appropriate introduction of product features such as the raw material is a delicate blend of luxurious essential oils, so that when burned, the candles help the users wind down (Relax), feel energized (Revive) or boost their libido (Romance), because too commercial advertisements may cause the audience to plan, and many people will choose to swipe away when they see a corporate account or an advertisement that is too obvious and direct. It can even cooperate with cinemas in the UK to get advertising promotion outdoors and the rights to broadcast advertisements indoors. Many people watch movies when they are free, and the cinema is also the place many people choose to date. Aromatherapy is an emotional product that can touch the hearts of these audiences to a great extent. People may want to give this fragrance as a gift after seeing the advertisement or buy it home to improve their quality of life. In conclusion, from the development of internet, there are more convenient and efficient way to do the advertisements.

This part will evaluate the sales promotions of soy candles from Alana Dotas, which will be discussed in three parts--free,win and save. Firstly, the common strategies of free include free extra value,free gifts,free samples.For this project can come up with such two marketing plans for both trade and en consumer of in-store and online , for both consumers who purchase certain amount we can send free gifts--new tastes of soy candles.Moreover,the firm can couple with more in-depth customer analysis, analyze customers' purchasing preferences to gift candles with corresponding scents to strength

consumer loyalty and realize the first aim of sales--aware of the product or service from AIDA. For in-store trade, the firm can use the strategy of free samples, allocate some samples to stores according to each store traffic and customer consumption habits, especially the stores in high-end shopping malls which have the most suitable target market--young people who have the consume habit of high-end luxury brand of home fragrances. Continuing, for the part of win, strategies can be competitions and free prize drawers. For more detailed plan, since Alana Dotas' target market is mid-high part young consumers, in order to get more efficient customer flow conversion and brand loyalty the firm needs to do more research to find the suitable place and time for this activity which can be guess the flavor of perfume, when consumers guess more than 60% they can get a new production of soy candles. From this competition, the firm can not only realize the aim of sales promotion, but also can distinguish the level of consumers' brand loyalty from the familiarity of the perfumes of consumers. In addition to free and win, save is also an important sales promotion in the market, which can be coupons and charity promotions. From the evaluation of the production, the most common important characteristic is environmentally friendly and the firm can focus on this selling point to do the promotion. For example, cooperate with environmental protection organizations, such as 2% of the income of each transaction will be donated to environmental protection organizations which can develop the brand loyalty of the consumers and also this way is directly to the end consumers which can be more efficient. Another way of save can be sent money off coupons, to attract new consumers the official website can send 10% off coupons to the consumers who are willing to receive the advertising emails from Alana Dotas which can also raise up brand loyalty. Consider the research of this part, every one of the sales promotion methods is very important, but to achieve the most efficient promotion methods need to do more market research and combine each methods with each other.

Last part of the article will cover the plan of database from direct

market--direct communication or distribution to individual customers.And the aims of direct market are to reach and engage individual customers directly; leverage individual customer information to provide them with products, services and offers most relevant to them and their needs; encourage trial, repeat purchases and brand loyalty.moreover, the key features of direct market are including direct response media; measureable and accountable;using and build a database.There are mainly three ways to build our databases--building our own list,renting or buying other people's lists,running competitions and other types of sales promotion to do data capture. From all the types of data, the most useful data are fragrance preference, consumption budget and usage habits of consumers. For individual consumers who have buying history, the firm can intelligently analyze their consumption habits, such as liking liquid perfume, balm or scented candles, etc.; analyze consumption frequency, and send email and SMS advertisements at the right time to increase consumer loyalty, and this kind of intelligent identification frequency sending advertisements is more important than sending advertisements often. Effective and more acceptable and not boring; analyze customer budgets, recommend products at the corresponding price, and make customers have a stronger desire to buy.To be focused, the costs between 3 and 30 times more to acquire a new customer than it does to retain an existing customer, so that the importance of retaining an existing customer is much more important than attract new consumers.Renting or buying other people's list is also a very common methods to build databases,especially for promotion of new type of production, finding the exist market research data to precise position their product positioning, such as on-trend fragrance, stylish look, suitable amount of weight which can be used to develop their product to attract more consumers and build selling points to distinguish their products with others.For running competitions and other types of sales promotion can be linked with the previous part of the article which has detailed expression of sales promotion and competition.From these ways,the firm can find personal such as

demographics; transactional such as buying history; promotional, what promotion triggered the purchase and with the full use of these data and market analysis can allow companies to make better and more accurate product strategic plans. Although, build databases and analyse them is a very efficient strategy, the firm needs to follow the General Data Protection Regulation which helps to protect the personal information of consumers.

This business idea has new product and new market. Soy Wax Scents is a new environmentally friendly range of fragranced soy wax candles is a new product of Alana Dotas. Because of the development of the internet and video apps, there will be more new ways to promote the product through media. So that Alana Dotas needs to analyse PR, advertising, sales promotion and direction market to get a better communication plan to promote their new product and increase their profit.

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